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Alvaro LOPEZ

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Engineering Executive
Hyperscale Infrastructure &
Open Source Strategy

Executive Summary

Infrastructure Executive

Global technology leader with over 20 years of experience bridging deep technical engineering with P&L strategy. I build and transform organizations that run the world's largest systems, aligning technical execution with multi-billion dollar capital investments to drive revenue and efficiency. Previously, as **Head of Engineering** at Docker, I orchestrated the turnaround that fueled **3x business growth**.

Current Roles

As Director of Cloud Platform at **Pinterest**, I oversee the strategy for a **$3.25B AWS commitment** supporting 600 million users. I drive Cloud Architecture and Operations, recently delivering **$125M in annual savings** and launching PinCompute, a Kubernetes platform handling 5,000+ monthly ML training jobs.

Concurrently, I serve on the **Technical Advisory Board of Inditex** (parent company of **Zara**, **€39.9B revenue** with a 20.1% operating margin). In this capacity, I advise the C-Suite on a **€2.7B digital transformation**, guiding global cloud architecture and "build-vs-buy" decisions for a network of 6,400+ stores.

Technical Credibility

Tens of millions of devices run code I personally wrote. I have been a GNU maintainer for 23 years and created Cherokee Web Server, deployed on the **International Space Station** and in every **GoPro** camera. I also **founded the Presto Foundation**, uniting Meta, Uber, and Alibaba to establish industry-wide data access standards.

I combine high-level strategic vision with deep technical expertise, ensuring that multi-year roadmaps are grounded in engineering reality. I bridge the gap between corporate objectives and low-level execution, validating architectural decisions from the kernel up.

Background

PhD in Telecommunications and M.Sc. in **Artificial Intelligence**, complemented by Executive Education at the **University of Chicago Booth School of Business**. I also served for 5 years as an Industry Mentor at **MIT** (Performance Engineering), guiding the next generation of architects in building scalable systems.

Global Reach

Dual **US-EU Citizenship** (USA and Spanish), providing full work authorization in the US and Europe, and the cultural command to lead across **AMER, EMEA, and LATAM**. I have built and managed distributed organizations of **120+ engineers** across the US, Europe, and APAC, including navigating complex geopolitical landscapes for teams in China to unify global talent and deliver round-the-clock engineering velocity.

Professional Experience

Mar
2025

Technical Board – Advisor — Inditex

Serving on the Technical Advisory Board for the world's largest fashion retailer (**€29.9B revenue** with a 20.1% operating margin), parent company of Zara, Massimo Dutti, and Pull & Bear among others.

- **Executive Governance**: Partnering with the **Board members and C-Suite** to steer a **€2.7B digital transformation**, defining the hybrid strategy across Data Centers, Public Cloud, and the **Edge computing** footprint in 6,400+ stores.
- **AI Strategy**: Shaping the strategic adoption of **Artificial Intelligence**, advising leadership on high-impact use cases that drive internal operational efficiency and improve the customer experience.

Jan
2024

Director of Engineering – Cloud Infrastructure — Pinterest

Leading the Cloud Platform organization and Capacity Engineering for a user base of **600M MAU**, managing a **$3.25B AWS commitment** and infrastructure supporting 300B+ Pins and 1 Exabyte of data.

- **Financial Strategy & Cost Optimization**: Managing daily infrastructure spend of $1.8M. Delivered **$125M in infrastructure savings** for FY2025 through aggressive capacity engineering and leveraging strategic commercial agreements (ISP/CSP/ODCR).
- **Architecture & Modernization**: Directed the migration to AWS Graviton, achieving **47% cost savings** and **62% carbon reduction** per API request. Leading the unification of compute platforms onto a global, federated Kubernetes (EKS) infrastructure.
- **AI/ML Infrastructure**: Launched PinCompute, a Kubernetes-based cloud platform scaling to handle **5,000+ ML training jobs monthly**, enabling the ML Platform, Ads, and Finance teams to execute multi-year growth strategies.
- **Organizational Leadership**: Evolved team culture, improving organization health metrics to an **8% detractor rate** (best-in-class) while executing a high-velocity migration roadmap.

Aug
2021

Nov
2023

Sr. Director of Engineering & Product – Cloud, Traffic, Edge Infrastructure — eBay

Led a dual Engineering & Product organization of **120+ staff** across the US, Europe, and China. Owned the end-to-end production infrastructure (1.2M pods, 150k servers) supporting **175M buyers** and $74B in GMV.

- **Capital Expenditure Strategy**: Managed an annual CAPEX budget of **$460M**, delivering **$600M/year in value** by strategizing a proprietary server-build program vs. public cloud (GCP) procurement to maximize margin.
- **AI & Resiliency**: Introduced **NVIDIA AI supercomputers** for large-scale ML training and maintained **99.98% availability** while managing massive organic growth, including a **105% surge in bot traffic** and 18% increase in API requests.
- **Security Architecture**: Orchestrated the transition from IP-based segmentation to service-based micro-segmentation (eBPF/Istio), securing a supply chain processing **300B daily data queries** while establishing a **Zero Trust posture** across **3,000 distributed applications**.
- **Global Operations Strategy**: Mitigated critical **geopolitical risk** for the Shanghai-based engineering center, executing a continuity plan that secured throughput and retained key talent, insulating the business from escalating US-China tensions while ensuring **zero operational downtime**.

May **2020** – Aug **2021**

Head of Engineering — Docker

Led Engineering, SRE, and Customer Support for the world's largest Container Repository during a critical corporate turnaround. Direct report to the CEO.

- **Turnaround & Growth**: Orchestrated the engineering transformation that fueled **3x business growth**, driving revenue from **$11M to $20M ARR** within 15 months.
- **Ecosystem Expansion**: Cultivated strategic technology partnerships with **AWS, Microsoft Azure, and Snyk**, aligning product roadmaps to expand the Docker ecosystem.
- **Global Operations**: Established a new European engineering hub, integrating Leadership, Product, and UX roles to optimize a fully remote, distributed workforce.

Mar **2019** – Dec **2019**

Leadership – Big Data — Meta

Directed critical initiatives within the **Data Infrastructure** Leadership Team, managing systems processing **300+ PB of data** to power interactive, low-latency analytics for critical business operations.

- **Industry Governance**: Founded the **Presto Foundation** (Linux Foundation), leading high-stakes negotiations to secure **Uber**, **Twitter**, and **Alibaba** as founding members while driving strategic adoption talks with **Netflix**, **Amazon**, and **LinkedIn**.
- **Big Data Architecture**: Led **Presto Engineering** and the Data Exploration **R&D group**, delivering the distributed SQL engine used for critical business operations while pioneering novel sampling techniques for low-latency analytics at **exabyte scale**.

Jun **2017** – Mar **2019**

Director of Engineering – Distributed Platform — Akamai

Reported to the CTO within Akamai Labs (**Office of the CTO**), leading the modernization of the Distributed Platform that serves **30% of global web traffic** across 250,000+ servers in **130+ countries**.

- **Platform Modernization**: Built and led the global engineering group responsible for replacing legacy architecture with a cloud-native **Kubernetes** solution, supporting **3+ trillion daily interactions** and **96 Exabytes monthly**.
- **Strategic Transformation**: Directed large-scale infrastructure orchestration initiatives and defined Akamai's corporate **Open Source strategy**, driving the cultural and technical shift toward cloud-native principles across the enterprise.

Oct **2012** – Jun **2017**

Global Manager – Cloud Infrastructure R&D — Red Hat

Manager of Managers for global R&D teams (NA, EMEA, APAC) focused on OpenStack and Cloud Infrastructure, while overseeing the RDO community and distribution strategy.

- **Market Expansion & Operations**: Spearheaded Red Hat's first Cloud Operations team and led the development of core NFV and OpenStack components, enabling the company's strategic expansion into the fast-growing Cloud Computing vertical.

Sep **2011** – Oct **2012**

Engineering Manager – Product Strategy — Canonical

Reported to the Founder & CEO, leading Product Strategy for Ubuntu, the OS powering **20M+ users**.

- **Innovation**: Directed the development of core Web technologies (WebKit, Chromium) and the porting of Ubuntu to smartphones and TVs, defining the strategy for **multi-device convergence**.

2008 – 2011

Head of Engineering, Founder — Octality

Founded the company behind the Cherokee Web Server, ranked as the world's fastest web server.

- **Global Execution**: Built and led a distributed engineering group across Spain, Mexico, and the USA, delivering high-performance infrastructure solutions adopted by governments and space agencies.

2004 – 2008

Technical Leader – Solaris Organization — Sun Microsystems

Served as Technical Lead for Solaris and Technology Evangelist for the Open Source Software group.

- **Open Source Strategy**: Played a key role in the committee that planned and executed the historic open sourcing of Java and Solaris, while contributing code to GNOME, ZFS, and the Linux kernel.

2002 – 2003

High Performance Computing Engineer — Espanix

1999 – 2003

Security Engineer — European University of Madrid

Qualifications

2019 – 2024

Industry Mentor – Performance Engineering — MIT

Serving as a mentor for Course 6.172, guiding students in the architecture and optimization of scalable, high-performance software systems.

2014

Data Science Specialization — Johns Hopkins University

Specialization covering R Programming, Data Analysis, Statistical Inference techniques, Regression Models, and modern Machine Learning algorithms.

2013

Global Senior Management Program — University of Chicago Booth School of Business

Executive Education focused on Strategic Innovation, Corporate Agility, and driving high-performance leadership in global markets.

2006

Ph.D. in Telecommunications — Complutense University

Certificate of Research Proficiency. Focus on Advanced Networking, Telematic Engineering, and distributed system architectures.

2003

M.Sc. in Computer Science (Artificial Intelligence) — European University

Master of Engineering with a dedicated specialization in Artificial Intelligence, Neural Networks, and Knowledge-based Systems.

2001

Graduate Diploma in Data Analysis — Royal Academy of Doctors in Statistics

Diploma in Data Analysis in Experimental Science.